
LAVYA JOSHI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

As a recent postgraduate in Modern and Contemporary Literature from the University of Manchester, I am interested in the intersection of Literature and Culture with a particular focus on the conception and representation of gender and sexuality. While my academic qualifications have helped me hone my skills as a researcher, my experience of working as a student ambassador and a contributor to various literary and media initiatives have also provided me with important insights on creative industries. Currently I am looking forward to gain some work experience in creative and publishing industries before resuming my academic journey via PhD.

EDUCATION

09/2023 - 09/2024 | **University of Manchester: Master of Arts in Modern and Contemporary Literature | Final Award: Distinction**

- Achieved a distinction for the research component of the coursework- A dissertation titled '*Writing Oneself to Freedom: Mapping the Contradictions in Indian Nationalism's Portrayal of Womanhood in the Works of Ismat Chughtai*.'
- Awarded Humanities Global Excellence Scholarship.
- Worked as a Postgraduate Student Ambassador (Academic Year 2023/24).
- Volunteered for the Student's Union. (Academic Year 2023/24).
- Attended the Sexuality Summer School, '*Queer Friendships and Other Intimacies*,' organised by the School of Arts, Languages and Cultures, University of Manchester. (May, 2024).

08/2019 - 05/2022 | **Manipal Centre for Humanities, Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Karnataka, India | Bachelor of Arts in Humanities (With a Major in English)**

- Completed the independent research project- A dissertation titled, '*Comics and Life Writing: Mapping the Interplay Between Medium and Genre*.'
- Finished the elective course '*European Literature in Indian Translation*,' offered by the Jean Monnet Centre of Excellence in India-EU Interdisciplinary Studies, MAHE.
- Completed a course '*Plagues, Witches and War: The Worlds of Historical Fiction*' authorized by University of Virginia, offered through Coursera.
- Worked as an editor for visual arts section in university level literary journal *Chaicopy*, where I—
 - Worked on ideation of themes for upcoming issues with the core team, facilitating workshops of finalised theme with members of the Visual Arts team to attract maximum submissions.
 - Worked with Editors-in-chief and graphic design team in finalising the cover design, layout, and content of the magazine.
 - Organised launch events at university level of three issues: *Ripples* (November 2020), *Dig In: The Language of Food* (April 2021), and *Mediums* (November 2021).
- Worked as a writer for the city level media organization *Manipal The Talk Network (MTTN)*, and—
 - Authored and co-authored various writing projects spanning across different genres including fiction, non-fiction, poetry, interviews, and global news.
 - Covered various events like TEDx, fests, international talks etc., on behalf of the organisation and interviewed leaders of global NGOs such as Desi Rainbow Parents, thus contributing towards diversifying the content and readership of the organisation.
 - Helped in the ideation of social media campaigns, like 'On the Brighter Side;' finalised the themes of various writing initiatives and collaborated with other writers for projects like National Poetry Writing Month.

- Worked as an editor for the Manipal chapter of the international college magazine, *Her Campus*, where I
 - Worked with several teams of writers across multiple categories like lifestyle, culture, and fashion to curate ideas for new articles and social media content; helped writers finalise their topics for various writing cycles, and guided them throughout the writing process.
 - Peer-reviewed and worked through various rounds of editing the articles submitted by my team and finalised the publishing layout; assisted the editorial board with ideation for new writing projects and content series.
 - Helped the managing committee with scheduling and organising department recruitments across various colleges within the Manipal Chapter, and also took part in various collaborative initiatives among several university chapters of Her Campus across India

04/2018 - 03/2019 | **Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram, Delhi, India** | **CLASS – XI/SCIENCE**

- Recipient of the Scholar badge for academic excellence.

01/2016 - 01/2017 | **Naini Valley Sr.Sec.School, Uttarakhand, India** | **CLASS - X**

POSITION OF RESPONSIBILITY

10/2023-06/2024 | **Postgraduate Student Ambassador, University of Manchester - Manchester, England**

- Worked as Postgraduate student ambassador for the School of Arts, Languages and Cultures (SALC).
- Contributed towards increasing communication between current students, staff and prospective students of the department by writing informational blogs, volunteering as campus representative during various events and organizing campus tours during university open days.
- Worked efficiently under tight deadlines to deliver content driven assignments while also managing full-time academic coursework.

09/2022 - 02/2023 | **Volunteer/Intern for expansion program, Nityanand Foundation Trust – Dehradun, India**

- Planned strategies for expansion activities undertaken by the trust in Dehradun and nearby areas by researching on policy and implementation in areas related to public health and development.
- Developed reports regarding environmental protection and social entrepreneurship initiatives undertaken by local groups and provided analysis of their impact in the region
- Content planning and organising promotional events for the trust.

SKILLS

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Creative Writing: Fiction and Non-Fiction • Academic Writing • Critical Theory and Practice • Research and Documentation • Project Ideation | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Close Reading • Proof Reading and Copy Editing • Blogging (Knowledge of WordPress and Canva) • Social Media Engagement |
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PUBLICATIONS

11/19/22 | '*Shah Rukh and The Sisterhood of Desperate and Disappointed Women*,' Review of *Desperately Seeking Shah Rukh: India's lonely young women and The Search for Intimacy and Independence* (2021) by Shrayana Bhattacharya for Atta Galatta-Bangalore Literature Festival Book Prize.

[Desperately Seeking Shah Rukh: India's Lonely Young Women and the Search for Intimacy and Independence | Atta Galatta - BookSmart](#)